FREE SAMPLE PAGES

Large-Print Christmas Story and Trivia Quiz with Answers

From the Christmas Past: An Advent Book for Seniors by Plainfield Press



The full 106-page book

A true story every day
24 stories in 16 pt print, each on a page of its own: the songs, films, television specials, toys, trees and traditions of Christmases past.

Answers one page-turn away
A five-question multiple-choice quiz follows every story, 120 questions in all. The answers are on the next page, each with a fun fact, and a score line keeps count.

A page to remember and share
Three Remember When questions a day to talk over with family, with lines to write the answers down. Every fact is checked against a published source, listed at the back.

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DAY 1 · A TRUE STORY

The Reindeer with the Shining Nose

In 1939, Robert L. May was given an assignment by Montgomery Ward, the department store based in Chicago. The store had been buying booklets to give away every Christmas, and it decided that writing its own would save money. May chose a reindeer partly because his daughter loved the deer at the Lincoln Park Zoo. He thought about calling it Rollo or Reginald before he settled on Rudolph.

The shining nose came to him as he stared out of his office window in downtown Chicago, where a thick fog from Lake Michigan had blocked his view. The idea was turned down at first, because in the 1930s a bright red nose was closely associated with drunkards. So May asked his friend Denver Gillen, an illustrator at Montgomery Ward, to draw some cute reindeer, and Gillen's alert, bouncy character won the managers over.

In its first year, Montgomery Ward gave out about 2.4 million copies of Rudolph's story. May's brother-in-law, Johnny Marks, turned the story into a song, and Gene Autry's 1949 recording went to number one on the Billboard pop chart. In 1964, Rankin/Bass Productions made Rudolph the star of a stop-motion television special, filmed in Tokyo.

Day 1 Quiz: Santa and His Reindeer

December 1 · The answers are on the next page

1. How many reindeer pull Santa's sleigh in the 1823 poem "A Visit from St. Nicholas"?

A. Twelve
B. Nine
C. Eight
D. Six

2. In the poem's first printing, two reindeer were named "Dunder" and "Blixem." What do those Dutch words mean?

A. Thunder and lightning
B. Moon and stars
C. Snow and ice
D. Wind and rain

3. In the 1821 poem "Old Santeclaus with Much Delight," how many reindeer pulled Santa's sleigh?

A. Two
B. Eight
C. Four
D. One

4. What is the traditional English name for the personification of Christmas, now usually thought of as Santa Claus?

A. Jack Frost
B. Father Christmas
C. Kris Kringle
D. Saint Nick

5. In 1863, which cartoonist published what is generally recognized as the first picture of the modern Santa Claus?

A. Thomas Nast
B. N. C. Wyeth
C. Haddon Sundblom
D. Norman Rockwell

Day 1 Answers

December 1 · Santa and His Reindeer

1. **C. Eight**
   The eight are best known as Dasher, Dancer, Prancer, Vixen, Comet, Cupid, Donner and Blitzen.

2. **A. Thunder and lightning**
   In Moore's own 1844 version of the poem, Dunder and Blixem became Donder and Blitzen.

3. **D. One**
   The 1821 poem was published in New York, and the names of the poem's author and illustrator are not known.

4. **B. Father Christmas**
   Father Christmas began in an old English folk tradition unrelated to Santa Claus.

5. **A. Thomas Nast**
   Thomas Nast drew for Harper's Weekly from 1862 until 1886.

Score: _____ **out of 5**